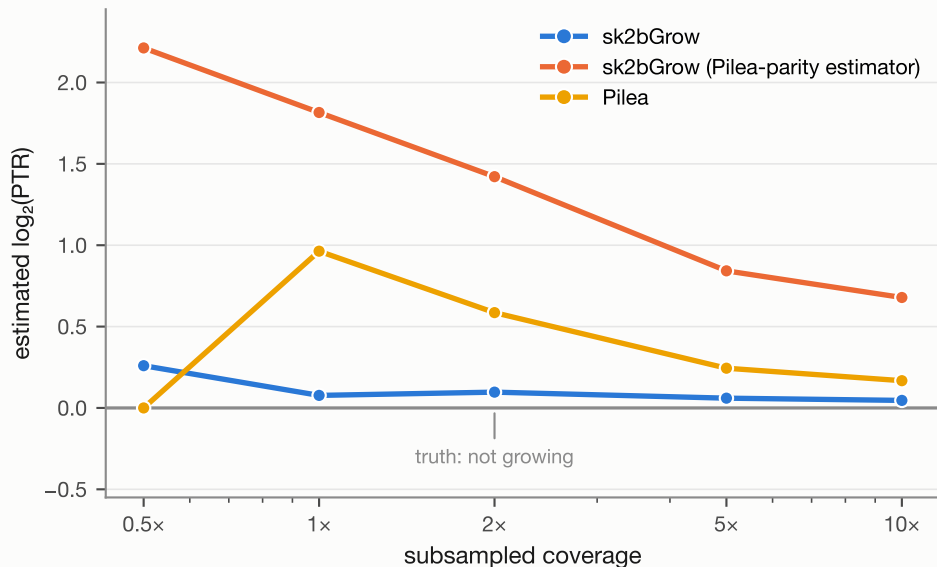


Negative control: a stationary-phase culture



The sorted-regression estimator reports $\log_2(\text{PTR}) = 2.17$ at 0.5x for a culture that is not growing — it manufactures a gradient out of rank-ordered noise. The coordinate fit stays within 0.11 of zero at every coverage. Pilea reports only at 10x under its own gates; the curve shown has them disabled.